Curated translation candidates: Mesopotamian texts beyond the flood stories

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Compiled 2026-10-16, after the flood corpus (`סיפורי-המבול-המסופוטמיים/`) was finished.
It is based on two surveys, both kept in `curation-surveys/`:

- **`relevance-survey--2026-10-16.md`**: about 60 Mesopotamian texts that scholarship connects with the Torah. Each entry has the specific parallels, the key studies and how well accepted the link is.
- **`availability-survey--2026-10-16.md`**: what can actually be obtained, checked against eBL (all 300 chapters), ORACC, ETCSL, CDLI, SEAL and public-domain or open-access books. It gives line counts, a measured preservation figure, licences, and the access mechanisms that work.

How the list is ordered

Relevance comes first: how much a word-by-word reader of the Torah gains from a careful Hebrew translation with an apparatus (guidelines §1).

Update (2026-10-19): the user's interest is wider than the Bible. In the user's words, it is "the soul of the ancient": how the Mesopotamians thought, felt, prayed and lived (guidelines §1, second purpose). The Bible ordering below stays, but from the next round a text also ranks high when it is a strong window onto the ancient mind, even with no Torah parallel. Tier 3 ("to expand horizons") is therefore **not** a low tier for this user; texts such as Ludlul, the Theodicy, the Descent of Ištar, the city laments, the love lyrics, the proverbs and the letters are full candidates.
Within that, the list prefers what the user asked for:

- texts in **good condition**;
- **medium or large** texts, or several short texts that make one corpus together.

Short texts appear only as part of a corpus, or as "quick wins" at the end.

Where the commentary stands matters too. The current work is **Gen 1** (the fifth day: the *tanninim*). **Gen 8:20–11:26** has no commentary yet. The legal and ritual blocks are drafted but thin.

Legend: **Lines** = edition lines; **Cond.** = condition, as measured in the availability survey; **Base** = the base text we would translate (guidelines §3, rank 1).

Tier 1: translate these (high relevance, good base text, good condition)

1. Enūma eliš, the Babylonian Epic of Creation (Tablets I–VII)

- **Lines:** 1,098, Akkadian (SB).
- **Cond.:** excellent. Tablets I, IV, VI and VII are ≥ 90% intact; V is the weakest.
- **Base:** eBL `L/1/2` (Heinrich), with 23–75 manuscripts per tablet and English on every line. King 1902 and Langdon 1923 are public domain, for history.
- **Torah:** Gen 1 almost word by word:
  - *tehom* / Tiāmat (a cognate, not a loan);
  - the sky made from half of Tiāmat, with a bar so that "her waters should not escape" ↔ the *raqiaʿ* (1:6–8);
  - Tiāmat's eleven monsters ↔ the *created* tanninim (1:21, the unit now being edited);
  - the stars, months and moon phases (V) ↔ 1:14–18;
  - man made from Qingu's blood to bear the gods' toil ↔ 1:26–28;
  - the gods' rest ↔ 2:1–3;
  - naming as an act of rule;
  - the bricks of Esagil and its "raised head" ↔ 11:3–4;
  - Marduk's bow set in heaven ↔ 9:13;
  - the divine warrior at the sea ↔ Ex 15.
- **Why:** it is the main external control for Gen 1, the text the commentary is working on now.

2. Creation and Eden companions (a small corpus with Enūma eliš)

- **Adapa** (eBL `L/1/7`: MB 78 + SB 97 lines; MB good). The bread and water of life refused, the garment, and wisdom without immortality ↔ Gen 2:17, 3:4–5, 3:21–22.
- **Enki and Ninmaḫ** (ETCSL 1.1.2, 142 lines; 31% damaged). Man formed from clay to free the gods from toil ↔ Gen 2:7, 2:15. The disabled people the gods made, each given a role ↔ Ex 4:11, Lev 21. *The Ex 4:11 link appears unpublished.*
- **Song of the Hoe** (ETCSL 5.5.4, 110 lines; excellent). Heaven separated from earth, and humans sprouting from the ground ↔ Gen 2:7, 3:19.

- **Enki and Ninḫursaĝ** (ETCSL 1.1.1, 305 lines; 21% damaged).
  - Dilmun, the pure land ↔ Eden.
  - Water brought up from the earth ↔ 2:6.
  - The forbidden plants eaten, and the curse ↔ 2:17, 3:6.
  - Nin-ti, "lady of the rib / of life" ↔ 2:21–22, 3:20 (debated).
- **The bilingual "Creation of the World by Marduk"** (CT 13 35–38, about 40 lines; good). It opens with a chain of "not yet": "no reed had come forth…" ↔ 2:4b–5. Base text: King 1902 (public domain) and the literature; check eBL and CDLI for a newer edition.
- **KAR 4** (about 70 lines; SEAL has a 191-line entry that needs checking). Humans grown from the blood of slain gods, and set to work the fields ↔ 1:26–28, 2:15.
- **Grain and Sheep (Lahar and Ašnan)**, the cosmogonic prologue (ETCSL 5.3.2, 193 lines; very good). Primeval humans "ate grass like sheep" with no bread and no clothing. Then grain and the ewe were given ↔ Gen 2–4, 9:3. This bears directly on the commentary's reading of Gen 2–4 as culture history.
- **Why:** the Gen 1–3 block is the commentary's centre. These texts together are about 1,000 lines, mostly well preserved.

3. Esarhaddon's Succession Treaty (SAA 2 6), with the Tayinat copy

- **Lines:** 691, Akkadian (NA, 672 BCE).
- **Cond.:** excellent (4% of words in brackets).
- **Base:** ORACC `saao/saa02` Q009186 (CC BY-SA 3.0); the English translation is in the HTML view. The Tayinat copy is P500551.
- **Torah:**
  - Deut 13: denouncing the prophet, the dreamer and the family member, and the rule not to add or take away (13:1).
  - Deut 6:5: "love".
  - Deut 28:26–35: the sequence of curses (Sîn → leprosy, Šamaš → blindness, the bride taken, the corpse for the birds).
  - Deut 28:23: bronze sky and iron earth, in reverse order.
  - Deut 28:53–57: cannibalism.
  - Deut 29:13–14: the oath binding future generations.
  - Lev 26:19.
- **Why:** these are among the most widely accepted lexical and structural parallels to the Torah, and they control *word order*, which is exactly what the commentary asks about.

4. The Laws of Hammurabi (prologue, about 282 laws, epilogue)

- **Lines:** 3,641 composite lines (about 1,400 verse-lines of text), Akkadian (OB).
- **Cond.:** excellent.
- **Base:** CDLI P464358, a composite with a normalization and English on every line, reusable with attribution. Check against the Louvre stele (CDLI P249253) and SEAL 7520 (prologue and epilogue, Streck).

- **Torah:** the whole Covenant Code (Ex 21–23), and much of Deut 19–25:
  - the goring ox, §250–252;
  - talion, §196–201;
  - deposit and the oath "before the god", §120–126;
  - herding liability, §261–267 ↔ Ex 22:9–12, Gen 31:38–40;
  - the river ordeal, §132 ↔ Num 5;
  - the unsolved murder, §23–24 ↔ Deut 21;
  - debt slavery, §117 ↔ Ex 21:2;
  - incest, §154–158 ↔ Lev 18;
  - the surrogate slave-wife, §144–147 ↔ Gen 16;
  - the prologue and epilogue (justice, the stele, blessings and curses) ↔ the covenant frame.
- **Why:** hundreds of exact contact points. The Torah's deviations (no class tiers, the ox stoned, no vicarious punishment) are exactly the "strange word" the commentary looks for.

5. Gilgameš, Standard Babylonian Tablets I–X and XII, with the OB Tablets II–III (XI is done)

- **Lines:** about 2,350 (SB) + 364 (OB II–III), Akkadian.
- **Cond.:** good overall. I and VI are good; IV is poor (59% of words in brackets); X is 34% and XII 30%. OB II is very good.
- **Base:** eBL `L/1/4` (George, 2026). The Hebrew must match the existing Tablet XI in the flood corpus.
- **Torah:**
  - Enkidu formed from clay (I) ↔ Gen 2:7.
  - His humanization by Šamḫat (sex, bread, beer, clothing; the animals flee him): "you have become like a god" ↔ Gen 2:20, 3:5–7, 3:21, 9:2.
  - Gilgameš, two-thirds divine, oppressing Uruk, who wants "to make a name" ↔ Gen 6:1–4, 11:4.
  - The seven years of chaff and the stored grain (VI) ↔ Gen 41.
  - Enkidu's curse and blessing of the harlot (VII) ↔ the curse speeches of Gen 3.
  - The quest for life, and Siduri ↔ Gen 3:22.
  - The guardian of the cedar forest ↔ the cherubim (3:24).
  - The raising of Enkidu's ghost (XII) ↔ Deut 18:11.
- **Why:** it is the ANE template for the passage from animal life to culture, which is central to the commentary's reading of Gen 2–4. It is also the best-known text in the corpus, and it completes the epic whose Tablet XI we already have.

6. The other law collections: Eshnunna, Middle Assyrian Laws A, Lipit-Ištar, Ur-Namma

- **Laws of Eshnunna** (CDLI P480696, 195 lines; good; normalization + English). §53 is nearly verbatim **Ex 21:35** ("they shall divide the price of the live ox and the dead"), the closest verbal parallel between biblical and cuneiform law. §54–57 has the goring ox with warning, and the vicious dog; §12–13 the thief by day and by night ↔ Ex 22:1–2.

- **Middle Assyrian Laws A** (ORACC `tcma`, P281779; 828 tablet lines; good; English by de Ridder 2021; CC BY-SA). Their Torah parallels:
  - §8, the woman's hand cut off ↔ Deut 25:11–12;
  - rape in the city vs in the field ↔ Deut 22:23–27;
  - the unbetrothed virgin ↔ Deut 22:28–29, Ex 22:15–16;
  - levirate-type marriage ↔ Deut 25:5–10, Gen 38;
  - veiling ↔ Gen 24:65, 38:14;
  - witchcraft ↔ Ex 22:17;
  - counted blows ↔ Deut 25:3.
- **Lipit-Ištar** (CDLI P464355, 503 lines; good) and **Ur-Namma** (CDLI P432130, 456 lines; fair). These are Sumerian, with prologues and epilogues; compensation for bodily injury ↔ Ex 21:18–27.
- **Why:** together with item 4 they make a full "cuneiform law" corpus of about 2,000 lines, which is the comparative background of the whole legal Torah.

Tier 2: strong candidates for a later round

7. Gudea Cylinders A and B (building of the Eninnu temple)

- **Lines:** about 1,300, Sumerian (c. 2125 BCE).
- **Cond.:** very good.
- **Base:** ORACC `etcsri` Q000377 (CC BY-SA) and ETCSL 2.1.7.
- **Torah:** Ex 25–40:
  - the plan revealed in a dream ↔ *tavnit*, 25:9, 40;
  - the people's purity and harmony during the building;
  - materials from distant lands, and the skilled craftsmen (Bezalel);
  - the god's entry into the house ↔ 40:34–35;
  - the seven-day dedication, with social equality ↔ Lev 8–9, Lev 25.

  Hurowitz 1985 and 1992 is the standard comparison.
- **Why:** the Tabernacle block has about 40 commentary units, many of them stubs.

8. Maqlû (I–VIII + Ritual Tablet), and Šurpu II–III

- **Maqlû:** 1,595 lines, Akkadian (SB); very good. Base: eBL `Mag/1/1` (Abusch) and ORACC `cmawro/maqlu`.
  - *Kaššāptu* is the cognate of `מְכַשֵּׁפָה` ↔ Ex 22:17 and Deut 18:10.
- **Šurpu:** the only legal full edition found is Zimmern 1901 (public domain, old).
  - Its list of sins ↔ Lev 5:1–4 (the unwitting oath, touching impurity), Lev 19, the Decalogue.
- Šurpu is more relevant, but its base text is weak. Look for Reiner 1958 in a library.

9. Etana, and Nergal and Ereškigal

- **Etana:** eBL `L/1/9`, 585 lines (OB, MA, SB); fair.
  - The barren king and the "plant of birth" ↔ the barren matriarchs and Reuben's mandrakes (Gen 30:14–16).
  - The eagle's ascent ↔ Gen 11:4 and Deut 32:11.
- **Nergal and Ereškigal:** eBL `L/1/6`, 87 + 333 lines; fair. The MB version has German only.
  - The "long stairway of heaven" (*simmiltu*) ↔ Gen 28:12, 17.

10. Sumerian culture and debate texts

- **Enki and the World Order** (465 lines; 32% damaged). The world is organized and domains are allotted ↔ Gen 1, Deut 32:8.
- **The debate poems**: Bird and Fish (191; ↔ the fifth day!), Hoe and Plough (201; very good), Summer and Winter (295; ↔ Gen 4:3–5?).
- **The Farmer's Instructions** (111; excellent) ↔ Gen 3:17–19, 9:20.
- **Enmerkar and the Lord of Aratta** (641; fair). The "spell of Nudimmud": the one language and its confusion ↔ Gen 11:1–9 (debated); the heavy mouth ↔ Ex 4:10.
- **Why:** these are the ANE's own culture-history myths, which matter especially for this commentary's thesis. Enmerkar is for Gen 11, a block that has no commentary yet.

11. Assyrian prophecy and royal inscriptions

- **SAA 9 Assyrian Prophecies** (ORACC; 11 texts; SAA 9 1 is 214 lines). "Fear not" ↔ Gen 15:1, 26:24, Deut 31:6–8; prophecy laws ↔ Deut 13, 18.
- **Sennacherib's annals**, RINAP 3 no. 22 (502 lines; excellent). Primarily for Kings and Isaiah; for the Torah, conquest rhetoric ↔ Deut 2–3, 20.

12. City laments and the Curse of Agade

- **Lament for Ur** (ETCSL 2.2.2, 442 lines; excellent).
- **Lament for Sumer and Ur** (2.2.3, 524; good).
- **Curse of Agade** (2.1.5, 321; very good).
- **Torah:** Lev 26:31–33; Deut 28:49–68 ("a nation of fierce countenance"); 29:21–27 ("why has the LORD done this?"). Primarily, Lamentations.

13. Justice and wisdom

- **The Great Prayer to Šamaš** (eBL `L/3/4`, 200 lines; very good). Two sets of weights ↔ Lev 19:35–36 and Deut 25:13–16; bribery ↔ Ex 23:8; interest ↔ Ex 22:24.
- **Advice to a Prince** (eBL `L/2/5`, 55; excellent) ↔ Deut 17:14–20, the law of the king (under-studied).
- **Counsels of Wisdom** (159; good).
- **The full Instructions of Šuruppag** (ETCSL 5.6.1, 288; fair), already partly in the flood corpus. "Do not move a boundary" ↔ Deut 19:14, 27:17.

Tier 3: to expand horizons (low Torah relevance, high literary value)

- **Ludlul bēl nēmeqi** I–V (eBL, 534 lines), the **Babylonian Theodicy** (288), the Sumerian and OB **"Man and his God"**: for Job, and for Deut 28's diseases.
- **The Descent of Ištar** (eBL, 159) and **Inana's Descent** (ETCSL, 440; good): the netherworld ↔ *sheʾol*.
- **Anzû** (694), **Poor Man of Nippur** (161), **Cuthaean Legend** (345), **Dialogue of Pessimism** (93), **Erra I** (191; Tablets II–V are not in eBL), **Lugalbanda II** (422; very good), **Bilgameš and Aga** (117; very good), **Agušaya** (SEAL), the **OB love lyrics** (ORACC AkkLove; for the Song of Songs).

Quick wins (short but very relevant; add to the corpus they fit)

- **The Sargon Birth Legend** (about 30 lines; NA) ↔ Ex 2:1–10: a basket of rushes sealed with *kupru* (bitumen), cast on the river, drawn out. It is not in eBL or SEAL. King 1907 (public domain) has the text; Lewis 1980 is ©. It fits the flood corpus's echo control (*kupru* / `כֹּפֶר`, and `תֵּבָה`).

- **The Edict of Ammiṣaduqa** (about 200 lines; OB) ↔ Lev 25 (*andurāru* / דְּרוֹר), Deut 15. Its availability is not yet verified.
- **The akītu ritual, day 5** (*kuppuru* with a ram's carcass; the ritual agents banished until the festival ends) ↔ Lev 16. Thureau-Dangin 1921 is the edition; its copyright status needs checking.
- **The OB herding contract** YBC 5944 ↔ Gen 31:38–40, Ex 22:9–12.
- **The "120 years" lifespan texts / the Ballad of Early Rulers** ↔ Gen 6:3, Deut 34:7. No open edition was found (see `סיפורי-המבול-המסופוטמיים/6-אזכורי-המבול/project.md`).

Methodological "negative" set (parallels that largely fail)

These are worth a short treatment to show *why* they fail, which suits the commentary's demand for rigour. The relevance survey §3 has the details:

- the Nuzi wife-sister and teraphim contracts;
- the Chedorlaomer texts;
- Dumuzi and Enkimdu ↔ Cain and Abel;
- the "rib" pun in Enki and Ninḫursaĝ.

Out of scope (not Mesopotamian), but among the most important comparanda

These are listed in the relevance survey §4:

- the Ugaritic Baal Cycle (Gen 1:21 *tanninim*, Leviathan, Deut 32:8–9);
- the Deir ʿAllā Balaam text (Num 22–24);
- Sefire and Tell Fekheriye (Fekheriye is half Akkadian; Lev 26:26);
- Hittite rituals (Lev 16) and Hittite treaties;
- the Ebla scapegoat texts;
- Egyptian texts for Gen 37–50 and Ex 1–14.

If the folder's scope ever widens, the Baal Cycle and Deir ʿAllā come first.

Update (2026-10-21): the rest of the world is now surveyed in curated-translation-candidates--world.md (ten regional surveys in `curation-surveys/world-survey--*`). The Baal Cycle is its first recommendation; Deir ʿAllā is in its Tier 1 #6.

Translation plan for this round (2026-10-16)

The user asked for the most relevant texts to be translated by subagents run **one at a time**; their own sub-subagents are also sequential.
The order puts the highest benefit per cost first:

Run	Corpus folder	Content	Status
1	סיפורי-הבריאה-המסופוטמיים/1-אנומה-אליש/	Enūma eliš I–VII (item 1)	**Done (first draft), 2026-10-16**: 1,098 lines, annotated per tablet, translation, parallels index (סיפורי-הבריאה-המסופוטמיים/parallels-index.md), print stub. Open decisions in its project.md.
2	סיפורי-הבריאה-המסופוטמיים/2-טקסטי-בריאה-ועדן/	the creation and Eden companions (item 2)	**Done (first draft), 2026-10-17**: all seven texts, 1,076 lines (Adapa MB + SB, Enki and Ninḫursaĝa with the Ur manuscript, Enki and Ninmaḫ, Song of the Hoe, the whole Grain and Sheep debate, the Founding of Eridu from eBL's BM 93014, KAR 4 from SEAL), annotated per text, translation, parallels merged into the corpus index, print stub. KAR 4 had a reliable base (SEAL + eBL). Open decisions at the end of its project.md.
3	חוקים-ובריתות/1-אמנת-הירושה-של-אסרחדון/	Esarhaddon's Succession Treaty (item 3)	**Done (first draft), 2026-10-17**: all 691 composite entries (SAA 2 6) + the Tell Tayinat copy (SAA 2 15: variants in the apparatus, Tayinat-only lines tagged {תיינת}), annotated in seven parts by §, translation with § headings, 771 parallels rows keyed to Deuteronomy by chapter (חוקים-ובריתות/parallels-index.md), print stub. New corpus חוקים-ובריתות/ (corpus.md, renderings.md). Open decisions in its project.md.
4	חוקים-ובריתות/2-חוקי-חמורבי/	the Laws of Hammurabi (item 4)	**Done (first draft), 2026-10-17**: all 3,641 composite lines of CDLI P464358 (prologue 1–303, §1–§65, end of §100, §101–§282, epilogue 3144′–3641′), checked against the Louvre stele P249253 and SEAL 7520; **the gap laws §66–§99 are not translated** (not in the base text; no open edition found). Twelve annotated files by twelve sequential sub-agents in priority order, translation with topic and § headings, 1,263 parallels rows keyed to the Covenant Code by chapter (חוקים-ובריתות/parallels-index.md, key findings at the top), shared law terms in חוקים-ובריתות/renderings.md §5, print stub. Open decisions in its project.md.
5	אפוס-גילגמש/ (new corpus)	Gilgameš I–X, XII + OB II–III (item 5)	**Done (first draft), 2026-10-18**: SB I–X, XI 209–328 (the sleep test, the plant and the snake) and XII – 2,474 lines, with XI 1–208 embedded from the flood corpus in the combined translation (הנוסח-הבבלי-התקני-1/translation.rtl.md); OB VA+BM (Šiduri), II (Penn), III (Yale) and the lesser Schøyen$_2$, Nippur, Harmal$_1$, Ishchali, Harmal$_2$, IM – 743 lines (הנוסח-הבבלי-2-הקדום/). Annotated per tablet, thirteen sequential sub-agents in priority order, 1,806 parallels rows (אפוס-גילגמש/parallels-index.md, key findings at the top), print stubs. Open decisions in both project.md files.

Run	Corpus folder	Content	Status
6	`חוקים-ובריתות/3-...` – `7-...`	Eshnunna, MAL A, Lipit-Ištar, Ur-Namma (item 6) + MAL B	**Done (first draft), 2026-10-18**: LE all 195 lines (CDLI P480696, with exemplars A, B, C), MAL A all 828 lines (ORACC tcma P281779, §1–§59 + colophon), Lipit-Ištar all 503 lines (CDLI P464355, Sumerian), Ur-Namma all 628 lines (CDLI P432130, Sumerian, with Civil's additional laws; § concordance with Roth by content), and the optional MAL B (P281780, 245 lines, §1–§20) – 2,399 lines in five projects, nine sequential sub-agents, three review passes each, shared tools `laws_*.py` with LH's formulas enforced, 678 new parallels rows (`חוקים-ובריתות/parallels-index.md`, key findings for Exod 21–23, Deut 22–25 and the rest of the Torah at the top), print stubs. Open decisions in each `project.md`.

Progress is recorded in each corpus's `corpus.md`.

Round 2 plan (2026-10-19)

After the first round (the six runs above), the user widened the aim to "the soul of the ancients" (guidelines §1). The second round mixes the remaining Torah-relevant texts with the strongest windows onto the ancient mind. One run at a time (quota); each run's sub-agents also sequential. (Runs 5–7 ran in parallel in Claude Cloud, 2026-10-21, guidelines §5.1.)

Run	Content	Corpus / folder	Status
1	**The Debate between Bird and Fish** (ETCSL 5.3.5) + **Enki and the World Order** (ETCSL 1.1.3)	סיפורי-הבריאה-המסופוטמיים/3-הציפור-והדג/, 4-אנקי-וסדר-העולם/	**Done (first draft), 2026-10-19**: Bird and Fish all 189 lines; Enki and the World Order all 465 lines (250–472 first); three sequential sub-agents, three review passes each, verified by script (`sumerian_tools.py`), translations generated, 255 parallels rows merged into `סיפורי-הבריאה-המסופוטמיים/parallels-index.md` with key findings (Gen 1:14, 1:20–23, Gen 4, 10–11, Deut 32:8), print stubs. Open decisions in both `project.md` files.
2	**Ludlul bēl nēmeqi** I–V + **the Babylonian Theodicy**	ספרות-החכמה-והצדיק-הסובל/1-לודלול/, 2-התאודיציה-הבבלית/	**Done (first draft), 2026-10-19**: Ludlul all 534 eBL labels (I–V, IV fragmentary) and the Theodicy all 288 labels (27 stanzas, the acrostic shown in the stanza headings), from eBL `L/2/2` and `L/2/1`, with Lenzi 2023 (open access) and the ancient commentaries; six sequential sub-agents, three review passes each, verified by script (`wisdom_tools.py`), translations generated, 1,012 parallels rows (Job first) with key findings (Elihu's healed man, Ps 27:10, 30:6, Job 19:13–19, 23:3, Deut 18:10–11, 32:39, the gods who made man a liar), print stubs. Open decisions in both `project.md` files.
3	**The Lament for Ur** (ETCSL 2.2.2) + **the Curse of Agade** (ETCSL 2.1.5)	קינות-על-ערים/1-הקינה-על-אור/, 2-קללת-אכד/	**Done (first draft), 2026-10-20**: the Lament for Ur all 442 lines (eleven *kirugu*, Emesal explained) and the Curse of Agade all 284 OB lines + the 37 lines of the Ur III version, from ETCSL with ORACC Q000379 / Q000375 lemma + morph (Samet 2014 and Cooper 1983 not available; Kramer 1940 open); five sequential sub-agents, three review passes each, refrains and gated words enforced by script (`lament_tools.py`), translations generated, 475 parallels rows (Lamentations first) with key findings (Lam 2:6 / Isa 1:8, Ps 89:35 and Isa 55:10–11, no sin of Ur, the failed intercession against Deut 9, Amos 8:9, Gen 3:17–19 in the curse of the clay, Dan 4, Josh 6:26), print stubs. Open decisions in both `project.md` files.
4	**The Gudea Cylinders A–B** (ETCSL 2.1.7 / ORACC etcsri Q000377)	בניין-המקדש/1-גליליות-גודאה/	**Done (first draft), 2026-10-20**: all 1,300 lines (Cylinder A i–xxx, B i–xxiv; RIME labels, concordance ETCSL = ORACC verified by script), from ETCSL with ORACC epsd2-royal lemma + morph and two rank-3 translations (ETCSL; ETCSRI, CC BY-SA); Edzard 1997 and Hurowitz 1992 not available. Seven sequential sub-agents, three review passes each, the Tabernacle words reserved and the building words gated by script (`temple_tools.py`), translation generated, 561 parallels rows (Exodus first) with key findings (Ezek 43:11's `צורה` not `תבנית`; Daniel's `פשר`; Ps 132:3–5; Hag 2:18–19; the stela named as at Bethel; 1 Kgs 8:13; Ezra 6:15; Isa 24:2; Num 27:8; no `כבוד`, no willing gift, no blessing but a decreed fate), print stub. Open decisions in `project.md`.

Run	Content	Corpus / folder	Status
5	**The Descent of Ištar** (eBL) + **Inana's Descent** (ETCSL 1.4.1)	העולם-התחתון/ (new corpus: the netherworld)	**Done (first draft), 2026-10-21**: the Descent of Ištar, all 159 entries (SB 1–138 with the pluses, NA1–NA11), and Inana's Descent, all 440 entries (1–412 with the pluses, two files); one Hebrew for the shared formulas; three review passes each; verified by `netherworld_tools.py verify --strict`; translations (19 + 24 footnotes); parallels index (172 rows, key findings); print stubs הדפסה/העולם-התחתון/. Translated by the coordinator itself (no sub-agent tool for a sub-agent). Open decisions in both `project.md` files.
6	**Enmerkar and the Lord of Aratta** (ETCSL 1.8.2.3) + **the Sargon Birth Legend**	אגדות-מלכים/ (Gen 11 and Ex 2)	**Done (first draft), 2026-10-21**: Enmerkar and the Lord of Aratta, all 641 ETCSL entries in four annotated parts (ORACC Q000369 lemma + morph for every word; checked against Mittermayer 2009, open access), and the Sargon Birth Legend, all 49 lines of King 1907 (col. I 1–32, II 1–17; transcribed from the page images; **to be checked against Westenholz 1997** before publication); three review passes per part; verified by `kings_tools.py verify --strict`; translations; parallels index (140 rows, key findings: the spell of Nudimmud is past and has לָשׁוֹן not שָׂפָה; Sargon's bitumen is *iṭṭû* = חֵמָר of Exod 2:3, not *kupru*); print stubs הדפסה/אגדות-מלכים/. Translated by the coordinator itself. Open decisions in both `project.md` files.
7	**OB love lyrics** (ORACC AkkLove) + **Sumerian proverbs** (ETCSL 6.1) + **letters** (a selection)	קולות-היום-יום/ (everyday voices)	**Done (first draft), 2026-10-21**: three projects, 1,513 lines. (1) שירי-אהבה-1/: all 25 OB / Old Akkadian love texts of ORACC AkkLove (LAOS 4 01–07, 10, 13, 14a–f, 15–18, and the love incantations 20, 22–26), 835 lines; (2) משלים-שומריים-2/: proverb collection 1 complete (194 proverbs, 348 lines) and a selection of 51 + 32 proverbs from collections 2 and 3 (152 lines); (3) מכתבים-3/: the Message of Lu-diĝira to his mother and eight Sumerian letters of private life (3.3.01, 06, 07, 08, 10, 11, 12, 20), 178 lines. Annotated files, translations, `parallels-index.md` (492 rows, key findings), print stubs. Translated by the coordinator itself. **Not done:** the OB Akkadian private letters (AbB: CDLI 503 all day; Archibab not allowlisted); the MB/MA love texts (LAOS 4 08, 09, 11, 12, 19, 21) and the Isin incantations.

Round 3 plan (2026-10-21)

Made by the lead of Round 2 after the user delegated the minor decisions ("decide minor things yourself"; "no purchases"). The six runs below are in **six different corpora**, so they can run at the same time, **each in its own Claude Cloud session** (one run per session): the session itself is then the coordinator and can start its translators as sub-agents (a coordinator that is itself a sub-agent cannot; guidelines §5.1). Every base text was

checked as reachable on 2026-10-21 (eBL chapter list, the local ETCSL bulk zip, ORACC zips with the `tools/certs/` workaround). If only one run can go at a time, the priority is the order of the table: Gen 8:20–11:26 has no commentary yet, so the texts for Gen 8:22 and Gen 11 come first.

Run	Content	Corpus / folder	Base text	Torah (look for)	Status		
1	**The Farmer's Instructions** (ETCSL 5.6.3, ~111) + **the Debate between Hoe and Plough** (5.3.1, ~201) + **the Debate between Summer and Winter** (5.3.3, ~295)	סיפורי-הבריאה-המסופוטמיים/5-..., 7 ,...-6-... (with Grain and Sheep, Bird and Fish)	ETCSL + ORACC epsd2-literary lemma + morph (check each Q-number in the zip)	Gen 8:22 (וְקֹר וָחֹם וְקַיִץ וָחֹרֶף), 3:17–19, 4:2–5 (the farmer and the herder), 9:20; Deut 22:10 (ox and ass), Lev 19:9 (the gleanings)	**Done (first draft), 2026-10-22**: all three (111 + 201 + 295 entries), one translator at a time (Summer and Winter, Hoe and Plough, the Farmer's Instructions), three review passes each, `sumerian_tools.py verify 5	6	7 --strict`; corpus renderings §9–§10; 259 rows in the corpus parallels index with key findings (Gen 8:22 as decreed fates; H&P 166–175 ↔ 8:21–22; the two brothers and the reversed verdict ↔ Gen 4; Gen 33 and Ps 133; Isa 28:23–29); print stubs.

Run	Content	Corpus / folder	Base text	Torah (look for)	Status		
2	**Etana** (eBL `L/1/9`: OB Morgan + Susa, MA Aššur, SB I–III, ~585)	`3/אגדות-מלכים-...`	eBL	Gen 11:4 (the ascent to heaven), 30:1, 14–16 (the barren one and the plant of birth), Deut 32:11 (the eagle), the serpent and the eagle's oath; the kingship "lowered from heaven" (Gen 10:8–10)	**done (first draft), 2026-10-22**: `אגדות-מלכים/3-אגדת-אתנה/`, 585 lines, four translators in sequence		
3	**The Assyrian prophecies** (SAA 9, all 11 texts; ORACC `saao/saa09`, CC BY-SA) + **Advice to a Prince** (eBL `L/2/5`)	new corpus `נבואה-ומלכות/`	ORACC (translations in the HTML view) + eBL	Gen 15:1, 26:24, Deut 31:6–8 ("fear not"); Deut 13, 18:9–22 (the prophet), 17:14–20 (the law of the king); the oracle of well-being	**done (first draft), 2026-10-22**: `נבואה-ומלכות/1-נבואות-אשוריות/` (652 lines) and `עצה--2-לנסיך/` (55)		

Run	Content	Corpus / folder	Base text	Torah (look for)	Status		
4	**The Great Prayer to Šamaš** (eBL `L/3/4`, ~200) + **Counsels of Wisdom** (`L/2/3`, ~159) + **the Dialogue of Pessimism** (`L/2/4`, ~93) + **the Instructions of Šuruppag** in full (ETCSL 5.6.1, ~288; partly in the flood corpus)	`ספרות-החכמה-והצדיק-הסובל/3-...` …	eBL + ETCSL	Lev 19:35–36, Deut 25:13–16 (two weights), Ex 23:8 (the bribe), 22:24 (interest), Deut 19:14, 27:17 (the boundary); Proverbs and Qohelet	**done (first draft), 2026-10-22**: `ספרות-החכמה-והצדיק-הסובל/3-...` – 740 , `...-6` lines (SH 200, CW 159, DP 93, SU 288); key findings 14–21 of its `parallels-index.md`		

Run	Content	Corpus / folder	Base text	Torah (look for)	Status		
5	**Nergal and Ereškigal** (eBL `L/1/6`, MB Amarna + SB, ~420) + **Bilgameš, Enkidu and the Netherworld** (ETCSL 1.8.1.4, ~300; the Sumerian source of Gilg. XII)	`העולם-התחתון/3-...,4-...`	eBL; ETCSL + ORACC	Gen 28:12, 17 (the stairway of heaven, *simmiltu*); 1 Sam 28; Isa 14; Deut 18:11, 26:14 (the dead and their provision); the fates of the dead by their lives	**Done (first draft), 2026-10-22**: Nergal and Ereškigal, all 420 lines (MB Amarna 87 + SB 333), and Bilgameš, Enkidu and the Netherworld, all 463 lines (Version A, UET 6 58/59/60, Me-Turan), Gilgameš XII's Hebrew copied where XII renders the Sumerian; three passes per part; `netherworld_tools.py verify NE|GEN --strict`; translations (14 + 19 footnotes); parallels index (551 rows, key findings); print stubs. Findings: Gen 28:12 (the stairway and the messengers), Gen 32:27 ("let me go ... before dawn"), Esth 3:2 / 5:9, 2 Sam 11:11, Gen 2–3 (the garden and the tree), 1 Sam 28; Gilg. XII translated from a Me-Turan / Urim-type text.		

Run	Content	Corpus / folder	Base text	Torah (look for)	Status		
6	**Maqlû** I–VIII + the Ritual Tablet (eBL `Mag/1/1`, ~1,600; ORACC `cmawro` as a second witness)	new corpus `כשפים-ולחשים/`	eBL	Ex 22:17 (*kaššāptu* ~ `מְכַשֵּׁפָה` [cognate]), Deut 18:10–11, Num 5 (the bitter water), Lev 14, 16 (the substitute, the burning); the witch's figurines and their burning	**Done (first draft), 2026-10-23**: all 1,595 eBL labels (I–VIII, RT) in `כשפים-ולחשים/מקלו-1/`, one translator resumed tablet by tablet, three passes per tablet, verified by `maqlu_tools.py verify --strict`; eBL lemmatized only Tablet I, so ORACC cmawro's glossary served as the lemma lookup (`maqlu_tools.py lem`; the cmawro zip has no texts, so it is not a second witness); the 131 lines shared across tablets fixed before drafting; parallels index 567 rows (key findings: Exod 22:17 and "she shall die, and I shall live"; Jezebel's death as a Maqlû curse, VIII B+6–7; the substitute who bears the sin, VII 132 ↔ Isa 53:11; the rites of Deut 21, Num 19, Lev 4, Exod 12 in the Ritual Tablet); print stub.		

For Round 4: see the merged "Round 4 plan" below (2026-10-22), which ranks these texts together with the non-Mesopotamian ones. **Waiting on access:** the OB Akkadian private letters (AbB: CDLI was down on 2026-10-21; Archibab needs `www.archibab.fr` on the allowlist); the MB/MA love texts (LAOS 4 08, 09, 11, 12, 19, 21: in

the ORACC AkkLove zip, not yet converted); the Sargon Birth Legend against Westenholz 1997 (not to be bought).

How each run session starts (the user, in a new cloud session): `ancient-translations: Round 3, run N` (the operator's option name, then the task). The session reads the guidelines, `STATUS.md` and this plan, briefs itself as `STATUS.md` §5 says, and runs its translators sequentially inside each text. **Shared files when sessions run in parallel:** each session edits `STATUS.md`, this plan row, `translation-guidelines.md`, `history.md`, `sources-registry.md`, `tools.md`, `domains.txt`, `sources/.gitignore`, `sources/fetch-recipes.tsv` and `sources/MANIFEST.json` **only at the end of its run, in one commit**, after `git pull --rebase origin main`; a conflict there is two additions – keep both. `MANIFEST.json`: add only the new items (a cloud `snapshot` drops the absent ones: `tools.md`).

Round 4 plan (2026-10-22)

Approved by the user on 2026-10-22. It merges two lists: the Mesopotamian texts left after Round 3 (above, formerly "For Round 4") and the first non-Mesopotamian texts, from the world survey (`curated-translation-candidates--world.md`). It starts when Round 3 is finished. **The runs go one at a time, in this order** (guidelines §5.1: quotas apply in every session, one agent at a time); start each with `ancient-translations: Round 4, run N`.

The order follows the commentary's priorities. Gen 1 is being written now, so the texts for Gen 1 come first, and a text rated HIGH for the Torah comes before one rated MEDIUM. A new language costs set-up (a converter from its base format, a name table, renderings with reserved-word gates, a translator brief) that a new eBL text does not. That cost is accepted for the strongest texts. Ugaritic is the cheapest new language: it is closest to Hebrew, and the Semitic renderings of the existing corpora carry over.

Run	Content	Corpus / folder (proposal)	Base text	Torah (look for)	Status
1	**The Baal Cycle** (KTU 1.1–1.6, ~1,370 tablet lines) + **the short Ugaritic myths and charms** (KTU 1.23, 1.24, 1.114, 1.100 + 1.107, 1.108, 1.82–1.83; ~560) + **the fifth-day dossier** (world list §5A: short excerpts from the other cultures, each from its own language)	new corpus `מיתוסים-אוגריתיים/`	the Copenhagen Ugaritic Corpus (Zenodo, CC BY-NC 4.0: git-ignored, with a fetch recipe); check Göttingen's EUPT first; DULAT; Cassuto 1951 (PD, Hebrew register check)	**Gen 1:21** (*tnn*, *ltn*, *bṯn*), 1:20–22 (the birds of heaven and the fish of the sea, KTU 1.23), 1:2, 1:9, 2:10, 7:11 and 8:2 (Baal's window), 9:20–27 (KTU 1.114), Gen 10 / Deut 32:8 (the seventy sons), Ex 15, Lev 19:27–28, Deut 14:1	planned
2	**The Edict of Ammiṣaduqa** (+ the Samsu-iluna fragments) – **only if an open base text is found**; otherwise skip to run 3 and leave it waiting on access	`חוקים-ובריתות/`	none open found on 2026-10-22: Kraus 1984 and Finkelstein 1961 / 1969 (BM 80289) are ©; CDLI answered 503 (check its catalogue when it is back)	**Lev 25:10** (*andurāru* = `דְּרוֹר` [cognate]), Deut 15:1–3, 12–18; the exemptions for foreigners and commercial loans (Deut 15:3, 23:21)	waiting on access
3	**Egyptian wisdom and creation**: the Instruction of Amenemope (551 lines, complete) + Merikare's creation passage (E 130–138) + the Book of the Heavenly Cow + the Memphite Theology (+ a few Pyramid Text "not yet" spells)	new corpus `חכמה-ובריאה-במצרים/`	AED-TEI (the 2018 TLA snapshot, CC BY-SA 4.0, on Zenodo and GitHub); El Hawary 2010 and Hornung 1997 (open access); Lange 1925 (PD)	Deut 19:14, 27:17, Lev 19:14, 19:35–36, Deut 25:13–16 (Amenemope); Gen 1:2, 1:21, 1:26–30, 2:7 (Merikare); Gen 1, 2:2 (Memphite); Gen 6:5–8, 8:21, 11 (the Cow)	planned

Run	Content	Corpus / folder (proposal)	Base text	Torah (look for)	Status
4	**Hesiod**: the Theogony + Works and Days (1,850 lines)	new corpus `הסיודוס/`	Perseus (PD text, CC BY-SA markup) + the Perseus treebank, through `raw.githubusercontent.com` or `git clone`; LSJ via Logeion	Gen 1:1–5, **1:21** (Keto ↔ the LXX's κήτη; Typhoeus ↔ Leviathan), 2–3 (Pandora; WD 289 ↔ 3:19), **6:1–4** (the demigods), 8:20–21 (Mekone), Lev 26 / Deut 28 (WD 225–247)	planned
5	**Erra and Išum** (eBL `L/1/5`, now all five tablets, ~750)	new corpus, or with the netherworld corpus (the coordinator decides)	eBL	Ex 12:13, 23 (*ha-mashḥit*), Deut 31:17–18 (*hester panim*), 32:22–25; the apkallū (Gen 6:1–4); the amulet use ↔ Ex 12:7, Deut 6:9	planned
6	**Hittite law and ritual**: the Hittite Laws (~200 §§) + the Instructions for Temple Personnel + the elimination rituals of Ašḫella, Uḫḫamuwa, Pulisa and Ambazzi	`חוקים-ובריתות/` (the laws, the instructions) + a new ritual folder (the coordinator decides)	TLHdig 0.3 (Zenodo, CC BY 4.0; per manuscript, so the composite is ours); the Mainz portal's editions (`hethport.net`, re-test); Hrozný 1922 (PD); the Chicago Hittite Dictionary per word	Ex 21–22, Lev 18 and 20, Deut 21:1–9, 22:23–27, 25:5–10, Gen 38 (the Laws); Num 18:1–7, Lev 22 (the Instructions); **Lev 16:8–10, 20–22**, Lev 14:4–7 (the rituals)	planned

Quick wins between the runs (short texts in existing corpora and with existing eBL tools; any session can take one when a run ends early): the Instructions of Šūpû-amēlu (`L/2/6`) and the fables (`L/2/8`–`L/2/13`) in the wisdom corpus (Proverbs; Jotham's fable, Judg 9:8–15); the Poor Man of Nippur (`L/1/11`, 161 lines; comedy, a new genre for the soul of the ancients).

Later (candidates for Round 5): from the Mesopotamian list – the Cuthaean Legend of Narām-Sîn (`L/1/12`), the Great Prayer to Nabû and the hymns (`L/3/5`–`L/3/7`), the Lament for Sumer and Ur (ETCSL 2.2.3), Anzû (`L/1/10`), Lugalbanda II and Bilgameš and Aga (ETCSL 1.8.2.2, 1.8.1.1), Sennacherib (RINAP 3 no. 22: high for 2 Kgs 18–19, low for the Torah); from the world list – its Tier 1 #5 (Vedic Genesis) and #6 (the Northwest Semitic inscriptions, once the user settles their format), then its Tier 2. The texts waiting on access (above) join whichever round their source appears in.

Each new language, before its first line (world list §8): a name table and a renderings file with the reserved-word gates (guidelines §5.2 ★); a translator brief for the language; a converter from the base format (CUC's Text-Fabric, AED's TEI, the Perseus treebank XML) into the folder's line data, with a `verify` tool; a transliteration convention for the Hebrew apparatus (Ugaritic, Egyptian); the base text's hosts in `domains.txt` (added 2026-10-21).